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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Purdue Pharma** and its owners from the Sackler family struck a new \$7.4 billion settlement of mass litigation alleging that they fueled addiction, reopening a path to end the longest and most costly corporate bankruptcy case stemming from the U.S. opioid crisis. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks advanced**, with the S&P 500 rising 0.5% to a record and the Dow and Nasdaq gaining 0.9% and 0.2%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **Trump said he expected** that steps by his administration to reduce energy prices would make it possible to keep a lid on inflation and bring interest rates down. **A2**

◆ **Boeing reported a loss** of about \$4 billion for the most-recent quarter, bludgeoned by a machinists' strike, troubled government projects and costs associated with layoffs. **B1**

◆ **CNN laid off** roughly 200 employees as the cable network comes to terms with a digital future and prepares to launch a streaming service. **B1**

◆ **UnitedHealthcare named** Tim Noel as its new chief executive after the killing of his predecessor, Brian Thompson, on a New York sidewalk in December. **B3**

◆ **The U.K. competition authority** is probing mobile ecosystems controlled by Apple and Alphabet's Google to determine whether it can impose bespoke rules on them under a new law. **B4**

◆ **American Airlines posted** higher-than-expected results for the most-recent quarter but disappointed Wall Street with its forecast for the current quarter. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump and his allies** used the World Economic Forum to warn the global elite that he intends to follow through on his "America First" promises, spurning allies in the process if necessary. **A1**

◆ **A judge temporarily** blocked Trump's order aimed at ending birthright citizenship in a setback for the administration's immigration agenda. **A3**

◆ **Russia shrugged at** Trump's pressure to bring it to the negotiating table over the war in Ukraine, saying that it saw nothing new in the president's threats. **A6**

◆ **Firefighters worked to** contain new blazes in Southern California, while persistent winds left weary residents on edge following weeks of historic fires. **A3**

◆ **Two centrist Republican senators** said they opposed the nomination of Pete Hegseth as defense secretary, injecting new drama into what was expected to be a close vote Friday. **A5**

◆ **The top lawyer at** Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency announced his departure just days after Trump's inauguration. **A4**

◆ **The lower house of** Ireland's parliament, the Dáil, voted 95-76 to make Micheál Martin taoiseach, prime minister, for a second time. **A16**

◆ **Two Iranian ships** docked in China were loaded with a critical ingredient to produce propellant for ballistic missiles, people familiar with the matter said. **A8**

◆ **A teenager who stabbed** three girls to death at a Taylor Swift-themed dance class in England was sentenced to a long prison term. **A16**

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President Trump remotely addressed the World Economic Forum on Thursday, where seated on the stage were, from left, Banco Santander Chief Ana Botin; Bank of America CEO Brian Moynihan; Patrick Pouyanné, CEO of French energy giant TotalEnergies; Blackstone Group CEO Stephen Schwarzman; and World Economic Forum President Borge Brende.

Trump Warns Business Elite: Produce in U.S. or Face Tariffs

By ALEXANDER WARD

DAVOS, Switzerland—President Trump and his allies used the World Economic Forum to offer the global elite a warning: He intends to follow through on his "America First" campaign promises, spurning allies in the process if necessary.

"My message to every business in the world is very simple: Come make your product in America and we will give you among the lowest taxes of any nation on Earth," Trump said in a video address from

Washington on Thursday. "But if you don't make your product in America, which is your prerogative, then, very simply, you will have to pay a tariff."

Expressing frustration at tariffs the European Union places on U.S. farm products and cars, Trump said the bloc treats the U.S. unfairly. "They put tariffs on things that we want to do."

His remarks offered a protectionist shot across the bow to U.S. allies and companies that hoped being friendly with the U.S. would mean fewer

penalties on their goods.

Trump also sought to take a firmer grip on global affairs, calling on the Saudi Arabia-led Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries to lower the price of oil. He suggested such a move could put pressure on Russia to call off its invasion of Ukraine, given much of the Kremlin's revenue comes from energy sales.

"The price is high enough that that war will continue," Trump said. "You got to bring down the oil price. You could end that war."

The Saudi government didn't respond to a request for comment.

Trump reiterated in his Davos address a desire to meet soon with President Vladimir Putin of Russia in an effort to quell the Russia-Ukraine war.

Trump's drive toward immediate negotiations has rankled European leaders, particularly

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◆ **Russia spurns Trump's push on war talks.....** A6
◆ **Alcoa says Canada tariffs would disrupt sectors.....** B6

Screens Are Taking Over In American Classrooms

Educators question whether the rapid shift toward more technology has really benefited learning

Class time has become screen time in American schools.

Kindergartners now watch math lessons on YouTube, counting aloud with the videos. Middle-schoolers com-

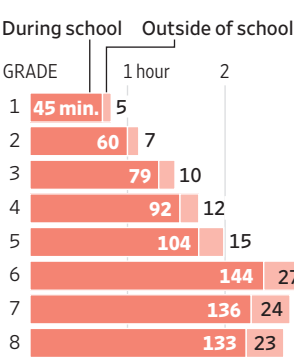
By Sara Randazzo, Matt Barnum and Julie Jargon

plete writing drills on Chromebooks while sneaking in play of an online game. High-schoolers mark up Google Docs to finish group projects.

The rapid tech transformation amounts to a grand experiment playing out in American schools. Accelerated by pandemic-era online learning, the move has happened with little debate, conflicting research and high stakes for the nation's children.

Educators wonder whether the digitization

Average amount of time per day students spend on school-provided devices



Note: Data from January-June 2024; includes 344 districts and 2.8 million students. Source: Lightspeed Systems

of the classroom has really benefited learning—or if it's done kids a disservice. Some teachers say online tools help create more engaging lessons and provide personalized instruction. Others say the screen-heavy approach has distracted students and burned out teachers.

"Covid really shifted things toward, 'Oh, we can do this,'" said Stephanie Galvani, a middle-school English teacher in suburban Boston. "But we didn't ask: 'Should we do this?'"

The shift runs counter to the prevailing advice from doctors and psychologists to limit tech use. Some frustrated parents are trying to opt their kids out of school technology, with varying degrees of success. Even some students pine for more analog methods.

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Stargate Deal Shows Microsoft Drifting Further From OpenAI

By TOM DOTAN AND DEEPA SEETHARAMAN

Microsoft's absence from OpenAI's Stargate announcement this week follows months of tension between the companies and signals a new era in which the longtime partners will be less reliant on each other.

At a White House news conference on Tuesday, the ChatGPT maker announced Stargate, a venture with Oracle and tech investor SoftBank. The new company plans to spend up to \$500 billion building new data centers in the U.S. to help power OpenAI's development.

The assembled leaders—OpenAI's Sam Altman, Oracle's Larry Ellison, SoftBank's Masayoshi Son and President Trump—discussed how AI could create jobs and even cure cancer. Microsoft Chief Executive Officer Satya Na-

della was thousands of miles away, at the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland.

The developments show how the OpenAI-Microsoft partnership that helped trigger the generative-AI boom is drifting apart as each company focuses on its own evolving needs.

In recent months, the two sides had been haggling over what to do about OpenAI's seemingly insatiable appetite for computing power and its contention Microsoft couldn't fulfill it even though their agreement didn't allow OpenAI to easily switch to others, people familiar with the discussions said.

OpenAI is almost entirely reliant on Microsoft to provide it

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◆ **OpenAI's 'Operator' tool automates tasks.....** B4
◆ **Heard on the Street: Oracle plays cheaply in AI.....** B12

Hot Spot for MAGA World Serves Bone Marrow, Not Burgers

Capitol Hill bistro captures culture shift among D.C. Republicans; 'No Budweiser?'

By MAGGIE SEVERNS

WASHINGTON—Donald Trump's allies are plotting his second term over organic wine and a new wave soundtrack.

Butterworth's, an all day cafe-and-restaurant in Capitol Hill that opened three months ago and serves food on vintage china, has become the hub of activity for the who's-who of pro-Trump operatives and media figures who mingle among tourists and neighborhood diners.

Steve Bannon, a former Trump aide and icon of the Make America Great Again

movement, regularly rents out Butterworth's for parties. A former co-host of Bannon's show, Raheem Kassam, is an investor in the restaurant who is often hanging out behind the host stand with a Guinness or fretting over a cupboard that won't stay closed. House Speaker Mike Johnson stopped by in December. And over inauguration weekend, conservative activist Scott Presler hugged Rep. Anna Paulina Luna (R., Fla.) just inside the entryway before heading to the Crypto Ball.

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Scientists Are Divided On Moderate Drinking

By BRIANNA ABBOTT AND JULIE WERNAU

It is a big year for booze, both for the people who drink it and the companies that make it: U.S. officials are set to sift through competing science on drinking to decide how much is too much.

Any change in the Dietary Guidelines for Americans—currently up to two drinks a day for men and one drink a day for women—could upend people's perception of their nightly tinkle with far-reaching consequences for the alcohol industry and the public.

The verdict on heavier drinking has been clear for years: It raises the risk for conditions including heart and liver disease and over half a

dozen types of cancer, resulting in some 178,000 deaths in the U.S. each year. The more drinks, the greater the risk.

The problem? The scientists don't agree on moderate drinking, and whether smaller amounts of alcohol are dangerous or could actually convey some health benefit.

One committee of scientists said last week one drink a day for both men and women raises the risk of death from several alcohol-related illnesses or injuries. The other group said last month moderate drinking was linked to a lower risk of dying overall compared with not drinking at all.

The Health and Human Services and Agriculture departments will consider both re-

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INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Walmart's regional store managers get a raise—to more than \$600,000 for some. **B1**

WORLD NEWS

A look at the U.S.'s long, volatile history with the Panama Canal. **A16**